Valkyries Win WNBA Title in Only Their Second Season

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The Golden State Valkyries beat the Atlanta Dream 68-63 in a thrilling Game 7 on October 31, 2026, to win their first WNBA **championship**. They made history as the first WNBA **expansion** team to win a title in just their second season.

An **expansion** team is a brand new team added to a league. The San Francisco-based Valkyries joined the WNBA as its 13th team in 2025 and won 23 games in their first season, more than any other **expansion** team.

Down by six at halftime at Chase Center, the Valkyries came back. Gabby Williams scored 28 points, a WNBA **postseason** record for points in a half, and hit a key late three-pointer to earn the Finals MVP award.

Word Treasure

expansion -- Here, a brand new team added to a sports league.

postseason -- The games played after the regular season, also called the playoffs.

championship -- The final contest to decide the best team in a league.

Background you need

An expansion team is a new team added to a league, often to bring a sport to a city that did not have a team before.

New teams usually take time to get strong, because they are built from scratch.

In playoffs, teams play a series of games, and the winner moves on to the next round.

Break it down

WHO: The Golden State Valkyries, the Atlanta Dream, and Gabby Williams.
WHAT: The Valkyries won their first WNBA championship in Game 7.
WHERE: At Chase Center, in front of their home crowd.
WHY: A second-half comeback and Williams's record 28 points sealed the win.

Why it matters

A new team winning so fast shows that even beginners can reach the top with teamwork and practice.

Test what you remember

1. What did the Valkyries win?

(A) A regular season game
(B) Their first WNBA championship
(C) A practice match
(D) A coin toss

2. What was the Game 7 score?

(A) 68-63 to Golden State
(B) 63-68 to Atlanta
(C) 68-68
(D) 70-60 to Golden State

3. When did they win?

(A) October 31, 2026
(B) In 2025
(C) Last week
(D) In 2004

4. What record did they set?

(A) First team to play 100 games
(B) First team to lose every game
(C) First team in San Francisco
(D) First expansion team to win a title in just their second season

5. How many games did they win in their first season?

(A) 23
(B) 13
(C) 12
(D) 32

6. Who scored 28 points and won Finals MVP?

(A) The coach
(B) Gabby Williams
(C) A Las Vegas player
(D) A Dallas player

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: A 3: A 4: D 5: A 6: B

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):